

# Apex Systems — RFP Response: Order Management Platform

## Executive Summary

Request for Proposal: Supplier response to build and support a cloud-based order management platform for a mid-size retail distributor, including integration with existing ERP and payment systems.

Apex Systems proposes a cloud-native, microservices-based order management platform built for scalability, resilience, and long-term maintainability. Our architecture has been proven across three prior deployments of comparable scale.

## Proposed Solution & Implementation Approach

The solution is built on a Kubernetes-orchestrated microservices architecture with an event-driven backbone (Kafka) connecting order intake, inventory, and payment services. REST and webhook integrations are provided for the client's existing ERP (SAP) and payment gateway, with a dedicated integration layer to isolate future ERP changes.

The platform is designed to scale horizontally to handle 10x current order volume during peak seasonal demand without architectural changes, based on load testing performed on our reference deployment.

## Timeline, Team Structure & Milestones

Estimated delivery: 20 weeks. Team: 1 solutions architect, 3 senior engineers, 1 QA lead, 1 project manager (all dedicated full-time). Milestone 1 (Week 4): architecture sign-off and ERP integration spec. Milestone 2 (Week 10): core order + inventory services in staging. Milestone 3 (Week 16): payment integration and UAT. Milestone 4 (Week 20): production cutover.

Risk plan includes a two-week buffer before cutover and a rollback plan to the client's current system if UAT exit criteria are not met.

## Price Table & Assumptions

Pricing assumes standard business-hours support during implementation and excludes third-party licensing for the client's existing ERP.

| Item                         | Cost (USD)  | Notes                                     |
|------------------------------|-------------|-------------------------------------------|
| Implementation (fixed price) | \$420,000   | 20-week delivery, team as described above |
| Annual support & maintenance | \$96,000/yr | 24/7 SLA, quarterly pen testing included  |
| Total Year 1                 | \$516,000   | Implementation + first year support       |

## Security, Compliance & Risk Controls

Apex maintains SOC 2 Type II and ISO 27001 certifications, renewed annually (certificates available on request). All data is encrypted at rest (AES-256) and in transit (TLS 1.3). Role-based access control and full audit logging are built into the platform core, not added as an afterthought. Quarterly third-party penetration testing is included in the support contract.

A named security lead performs a dedicated architecture security review at Milestone 1.

## **Support Model, Relevant Experience & References**

24/7 support with a 1-hour critical-incident response SLA. Apex has delivered two prior order-management platforms for retail distributors of similar size (references available on request, NDA required). Support is staffed by the original delivery engineers for the first 6 months post-launch.